

Decent Coaching Classes

X SB

Academic Conquest - VI

Answer Key & Marking Scheme

Subject : Political Science (Std. X)

Marks : 30

Q.1 (A)

[4]

(1) (c) 21 (2) (b) Sukumar Sen (3) (a) Delimitation (4) (c) 1980 — 1 mark each

(B)

[4]

(1) – (c) Maharashtra (2) – (b) Punjab (3) – (a) Jammu and Kashmir (4) – (d) Assam — 1 mark each

[(e) Tamil Nadu is the extra option.]

Q.2 (Any 3 — 1 mark for True/False + 1 mark for reason)

[6]

- (1) False. The Right to Information has made the Government more transparent and has reduced the element of secrecy in its working.
- (2) True. Parties communicate the demands and complaints of the people to the Government, and the Government seeks people's support for its policies and programmes through them.
- (3) False. The Election Commission has no separate staff; Government officers, teachers and other employees help it to carry out the election process.
- (4) False. The belief that coalition governments bring instability was proved wrong; the coalition system has become stable in India (BJP and Congress both ran coalition governments).

Q.3 (Any 2 — 2 marks each)

[4]

- (1) Rights based approach : In the decades after independence, citizens were treated as beneficiaries of development. In recent decades, development is considered the right of citizens (e.g. Right to Information, Right to Education, Right to Food Security). This strengthens democracy and changes the relation between the Government and citizens.
- (2) Midterm elections : If an elected government loses its majority before completing its term, or if coalition partners withdraw support and no alternative government is possible, elections are held before the term ends. These are called midterm elections.
- (3) Regionalism : Affinity for one's language and region gradually turns into identity consciousness. People think first of the interests and development of their own region and feel proud of its language, culture and history. This gives rise to regional parties, pressure groups and movements.

Q.4 (Any 3 — 2 marks each)

[6]

- (1) The young generation got an opportunity for political participation; India has the largest number of voters of any democracy and became the largest democracy in the world; new political parties emerged with the active support of young voters, representing various expectations of the people.
- (2) Any two : preparing and updating the voters list and issuing identity cards; deciding the timetable and programme of elections; scrutiny of candidates' applications; recognising (or de-recognising) political parties and allotting symbols; resolving election disputes (disqualifying a candidate or ordering re-election).
- (3) The Code of Conduct is a set of rules adopted by the Election Commission to ensure free and fair elections. It states the rules to be followed by the Government, political parties and voters before and during elections. Even the Government cannot violate it.
- (4) Any two : to be in power through elections; to pursue an ideology; to have a party agenda; to establish a government (the majority party rules, others act as opposition); to act as a link between the Government and the people.

Q.5 (A) Any two correct entries — 1 mark each

[2]

Candidates with criminal background (criminalisation of politics); family monopoly in politics (tickets to relatives).

(B) Any one

[4]

(1) Changing nature of the party system : (i) After independence, Congress dominated the Centre and most States — "Single dominant party system". (ii) In 1977 non-Congress parties came together and challenged this system. (iii) After the 1989 Lok Sabha elections the single dominant party system ended and coalition governments began; both BJP and Congress experimented with coalitions, which proved stable. [Three points — 1+1+2 marks, or 1 mark per point + 1 for presentation.]

(2) Role of the Judiciary : (i) Basic structure — Parliament can amend the Constitution but cannot alter its basic structure (republican and democratic form, federal structure, unity and integrity, sovereignty, secularism). (ii) Significant judgements — on rights of children, human rights, honour and dignity of women, individual freedom and tribal empowerment, making fundamental rights more meaningful and the political process more mature. (iii) Judiciary has always considered the objectives and intentions of the Constitution makers. [Any 4 points — 1 mark each.]